

42ND STREET | THURSDAY NIGHT

Empty. Eerie. Quiet. Lights flicker on and off, above and in the depths of the tracks. An announcement that turns into something garbled. A train horn sounds. The lights flicker off. Screeching. The rush of wind.

CLINT

(announcement)

The MTA would like to remind you, boys are waiting on each platform to distract you. Should you need help or a reason to feel alive today, please seek one out.

Subway doors open.

CLINT (CONT'D)

Stand clear of the closing doors, please.

The subway doors close.

COMPANY

42nd Street Station. Thursday night.

The lights reveal a sleep deprived Alpheus and a smug Andy. The Chorus travels up and down steps, in and out of the station. Alpheus fiends after them, crossing to talk to them but pulling himself back. He resorts to Andy, who vapes and watches Alpheus's journey.

ALPHEUS

Can I hit that?

ANDY

(blowing out smoke)

It's called Fucking Fab.

ALPHEUS

(wipes the vape on his shirt)

You told me you were going to quit before you leave.

ANDY

I have a week left. What's your point?

ALPHEUS

I thought /

ANDY

You just asked me to hit it.

ALPHEUS

I did.

ANDY

You run.

ALPHEUS

Yeah, and?

ANDY

So, why are you vaping?

ALPHEUS

Why are you? You promised you'd quit.

ANDY

The way I see it, I have to reward myself.

ALPHEUS

For what?

ANDY

Surviving this city. It tried to kill me.

ALPHEUS

Quit being so dramatic. The city doesn't want you dead.

ANDY

You weren't here the last three years. Come to think of it, you never visited me. Not once.

ALPHEUS

You never invited me.

ANDY

Oh, pull my fucking leg.

(vapes)

(MORE)

ANDY (CONT'D)

I invited you several times. And you told me no each and every time. At the last second.

ALPHEUS

You would invite me two weeks before. You know I don't travel, especially last minute.

ANDY

I know, I'm surprised you came this time.

(vapes and hands it to Alpheus)

Keep her safe. I'll be done with it when I leave.

ALPHEUS

(vapes)

For good?

ANDY

For good. So, what are we doing tonight?

ALPHEUS

I think we should see a show.

ANDY

You told me no show tonight. You told me you'd be too tired.

ALPHEUS

I lied.

THE COMPANY

The show.

The chorus assembles to portray a tableau of a musical. They hang from the stairs, sit on the edge of the stage, run up to interact with the audience. Alpheus and Andy sit with their back to the audience.

ANDY

Christian Souza.

ALPHEUS

Christian?

ANDY

He's in this show. Made my mother cry when she saw him.

ALPHEUS

What's so special /

ANDY

Just shut up and watch.

The Chorus freezes.

Blackout.

The chorus ad libs a show in the dark.

They stop.

A light. Christian appears. Seductive. Alpheus stands. He approaches Christian.

ALPHEUS

How did you do that? How does a sound like that come out of a boy like you?

(to the audience)

He's the final piece of art that makes that 400 square foot sublet in Brooklyn feel finally like... a home. Like a reason to move here. A reason to put up with the God damn heat, the subway smells, the rent prices and that seductive frustration of living here that doesn't exist anywhere else in the world.

ANDY

Hellooo. I'm sorry, are you busy? Where's your head at?

ALPHEUS

I don't know.

(to the station)

Should I do it?

THE COMPANY

Do what?

ALPHEUS

Reach out to him.

THE COMPANY

Why?

ALPHEUS

Because he's beautiful.

Screeching. Blackout. Christian is gone.

The lights snap back.

Alpheus and Andy sit on opposite sides of a subway car. The rest of the car is filled with the Chorus.

CHORUS

To Christian.

ALPHEUS

Got to see you tonight and just wanted to say you
were absolutely incredible. I need a cast recording.

Alpheus dozes. The company rattles. A homeless man walks around and boasts about the bible and following Jesus and how he's the only way. An announcement.

CHRISTIAN

What are you in town for?

ALPHEUS

(half awake)

My friend is graduating.

CHRISTIAN

Tell him congratulations.

ALPHEUS

Christian says congratulations.

ANDY

Who the fuck is Christian?

ALPHEUS

Souza.

ANDY

Christian Souza?

ALPHEUS

Yes.

ANDY

I don't know that girl.

ALPHEUS

Yes, you do. The guy we saw tonight.

ANDY

You mean the fucking lead? Like Christian Souza.

ALPHEUS

Yes. That's what I said.

ANDY

Why are you talking to him? He answered you? Did you talk to him first, or did he reach out to you? Is he even gay?

ALPHEUS

He might be. I don't think so.

ANDY

Alpheus.

ALPHEUS

What?

ANDY

You know these boys don't want you that way. Not the way you want them.

ALPHEUS

Well, I never said I wanted him.

ANDY

Doesn't matter. I can see it in your eyes.

ALPHEUS

See what?

ANDY

That you're into him.

ALPHEUS

Why do you think I want to be with him?

ANDY

Because of the way you're defending yourself.

ALPHEUS

He's sweet. That's all.

ANDY

Oh, he's sweet? You know guys like him are only sweet to you because they want to fuck you.

ALPHEUS

Well, I don't want to fuck him. It's not like that. Look, I don't know how to explain it, but there's something different about him.

ANDY

You think he could be the one?

ALPHEUS

Well /

ANDY

I thought you didn't want him like that.

ALPHEUS

I don't.

ANDY

So you don't want to hook up with him.

ALPHEUS

No! I don't want to hook up with anyone.

ANDY

Don't take your prudence out on me. I get it. You want a connection. If you have to hook up to get it, you'll do that. And that's ok.

ALPHEUS

I don't want to hook up with him. I just thought he'd be a good connection if I moved here.

ANDY

Then why'd you bring your douche?

ALPHEUS

How do you know I brought it?

ANDY

I didn't know. You just told me.

ALPHEUS

Well, I'm not going to use it.

ANDY

Then why bring it?

ALPHEUS

To be safe.

ANDY

Uh huh. Fine. Go hang out with him. You'll feel alone afterwards. Once you go back home. He'll be 1,500 miles away.

ALPHEUS

I'm here for a whole week.

ANDY

You think that's enough time?

ALPHEUS

I don't know.

ANDY

Is he going to make you happy?

ALPHEUS

I don't know him, Andy.

ANDY

That didn't answer my question.

ALPHEUS

I'd like to spend time with him.

ANDY

But do you think a boy will make you happy or happier?

ALPHEUS

If he wants to hang out, I'm not going to say no. When am I going to get another chance like this?

ANDY

You're right. You won't be here forever. In a few days, that train is gonna come back and take both of us. You might as well make the most of it.

The subway stops. The doors open.

CLINT

You don't have to listen to him, you know. Maybe, just maybe, you're being a boy, in a big city, with big wants. It's okay to go out. It's ok to talk to boys. Maybe you'll find someone you can stay with, at least a few more days.

ALPHEUS

I have some propositions from people.

A series of recorded calls from the Chorus.

BOY 1

Rooftop shoot tomorrow morning?

BOY 2

Party at Boom Boom tomorrow night. Show up at my studio. I'll take you out. My treat.

BOY 3

I have a photoshoot for you this week. Can you change your flight?

ALPHEUS

But I don't have a place to stay if I say yes to the last shoot.

CLINT

I have a timeshare, but you have to go pick up the key.

ALPHEUS

Can I bring a boy over? Hypothetically.

CLINT

He better be a good fuck.

The doors open and close. The chorus departs.

ALPHEUS

Are you going to be mad at me if I meet up with him?

ANDY

No. How could I be? You're chasing the same thing you always chase.

ALPHEUS

No, this time it's real.

ANDY

You came all the way here just to run around with boys. I get it.

ALPHEUS

I want to hang out with you. I really do.

ANDY

I know you do.

ALPHEUS

But there are people here who want to see me.

ANDY

I understand that.

ALPHEUS

Does that make you jealous?

ANDY

Nope. Not one bit.

Alpheus and Andy hug for a long time. Alpheus chooses a set of stairs to walk up, stops, and heads to the other set. He stops, returns to the middle.

ANDY (CONT'D)

It doesn't matter which set of stairs you walk up.

Andy hands Alpheus his vape. He takes it and chooses a set of stairs.

ANDY (CONT'D)

You're always going to be unhappy. Sad. Because that's who you are at heart. Miserable. Because you choose to be when you wake up. Happiness is a choice you choose not to make. But no, I'm not mad at you.

The lights flicker off. A homeless man wails into the night.